third and final date. The months between June and October 1973 were essential for Egypt to receive the equipment it had been lacking and to begin putting it to use before the war began.

Strategic Aspects of the Preparations for War

In early May 1973, a Mossad source reported that Sadat was about to conclude negotiations with the oil-producing Arab states regarding the cessation of the supply of oil to Western countries immediately following the outbreak of the war.

- Toward mid-1973, the Mossad reported an Egyptian decision to impose a closure on the Straits of Bab al-Mandeb (between the Red Sea and the Indian Ocean) and to deploy commando fighters at the entrance to the Gulf of Eilat immediately upon the outbreak of hostilities.
- At the end of 1972, the Mossad reported a Syrian demand for cooperation with Jordan, asking for the latter to commit to securing the southern flank of the Syrian front in order to prevent the IDF from crossing into Jordan and reaching the southern front. As the war neared, intelligence came in confirming that King Hussein had indeed agreed to the Syrian request.

Conclusion

In the forty-three years that have passed since the Yom Kippur War, from time to time pundits of various kinds pop up—particularly in the media—who see it as their duty to relieve Military Intelligence of the burden of complete responsibility for the colossal failure and to assign some of this burden to the Mossad. Every year when the anniversary of the outbreak of the war, October 6, approaches, the level of noise emanating from the media begins to rise. Documents and reports related to the war and the Agranat Commission are published from time to time, based on arbitrary rules derived from the laws regarding the publication of classified information. Each one of these episodes reopens all the wounds of the trauma of the Yom Kippur War. It must be remembered that the Agranat Commission investigated only the first three days of the war. The question must be asked: For how many decades can we continue the ritual of this self-